## ONCE UPON A TAP



Uttar Pradesh CM **Yogi Adityanath** turned 54 on June 5, and the event was marked with 54 kilos of laddoos, bulldozer-shaped cakes, and much celebrations. Yogi also used the occasion to highlight what his government has done, especially under the Har Ghar Nal Yojana, providing tap water connections to all. In the same breath, however, he also spoke of '*toti chori*' (stealing of taps), reviving an old BJP taunt against Opposition leader **Akhilesh Yadav**. In 2018, after the Samajwadi Party chief had vacated the official CM's residence, allegations had been made about missing taps. Keen to plug that dripping rumour, Akhilesh took to X, sharing Yogi's clip, and calling him 'CM, that is, Corrupt Mouth'.



## STATE BANK OF TDP



A ghat on the banks of the Godavari near Rajahmundry, allegedly named after **Nara Lokesh's** 11-year-old son Devaansh, has left the Telugu Desam scion and Andhra Pradesh IT minister embarrassed. A video of the 'Devaansh Ghat' went viral after the district administration said it was remodelling it at a cost of Rs 1 crore ahead of next year's Godavari Pushkarams, the once-in-12-years holy bathing festival. Lokesh has called any connection with his son "ridiculous", but netizens have pointed to the July 2015 date on the ghat's arch to argue that it was built during the TDP's earlier regime.

## KNOW YOUR BIHAR



Bihar has often seen politicians on yatras, but CM **Samrat Choudhary** has outsourced the tradition. Rather than doing a state tour himself, he has instructed his babus to do the travelling. Under the Bihar Darshan initiative, all officials have been directed to visit tourist destinations with their families and submit photos and reports of their experiences. Samrat's message seems clear: if Bihar is worth governing, it is worth seeing. Guess he wants the babus to discover first-hand the wonders of 'Blissful Bihar'.

**Kaushik Deka with Avaneesh Mishra, Prasad Nichenametla and Amitabh Srivastava**

**HEALTH WATCH**

## ROTAVIRUS VACCINE
# AN IMPROVED COVERAGE

*By* **Sonali Acharjee**

One of the standout findings from the sixth round of the National Family Health Survey (NFHS-6) is the dramatic rise in rotavirus vaccination coverage among Indian children. Coverage has more than doubled since NFHS-5, increasing from 36.4 per cent to over 85 per cent, making it one of the fastest-growing components of the immunisation programme.

The achievement matters as rotavirus is a leading cause of severe diarrhoea in infants and young children. While diarrhoea may sound like a routine childhood illness, severe cases can lead to dehydration, hospitalisation and, in vulnerable settings, even death. For years, rotavirus-related illness placed a big burden on families and healthcare systems, particularly in rural and low-resource communities.

The sharp increase in vaccine uptake suggests that India has successfully expanded access to a relatively newer vaccine through its public health system. It is also an indicator that more parents are receiving timely childhood immunisations and that frontline health workers are reaching families who may previously have been left out.



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The rotavirus gains are part of a broader immunisation success story. NFHS-6 found that full immunisation coverage among children aged 12–23 months rose to 87.1 per cent, while more than 96 per cent received at least one vaccine. The second dose coverage of the vaccine that contains measles also improved significantly. Taken together, the findings suggest that India is steadily closing longstanding immunisation gaps.